



• VST3 • AU • STANDALONE

DRUM MACHINE

SAMPLER

SYNTH OR SAMPLE

A 16-step drum machine with eight synthesised voices, a sampler and an effects rack.



USER MANUAL

1.0.0 VER

VOICES

8



WHAT'S INSIDE

01	GETTING STARTED	03
	Installing, the demo, the window	
02	THE SEQUENCER	05
	Grid, chain, swing, accent, undo	
03	THE VOICES	07
	Engines, SAMPLE mode, the three menus	
04	KITS AND GROOVES	10
	Synth and sample kits, 136 grooves	
05	THE SAMPLE LIBRARY	11
	68 machines, naming, where it lives	
06	THE BROWSER	13
	One list, one search box	
07	THE EFFECTS RACK	14
	Eight modules, inserts and sends	
08	LINKING WITH MASTER RACK	16
	SYNC MASTER RACK, what travels	
09	BOUNCE AND MIDI OUTPUT	18
	Stems, mix with and without rack	
10	AUTHORISATION	19
	Demo, serial, unlock	

ABOUT THE FIGURES

The figures are snapshots of the real window, retaken at every build: what you see here is what opens in your host. The enlarged controls are the Blender renders the plugin's skin is built from.

01 — GETTING STARTED

EIGHT VOICES. SYNTH OR SAMPLE.

*Mix them freely: a sampled 909 kick with a synthesised 808
snare.*

AudioXL DRUMS is a **16-step, eight-voice drum machine**, available as **VST3, Audio Unit and a standalone application**. Each voice can be an analogue-style synthesis engine or a sample, and the two mix freely: a sampled 909 kick with a synthesised 808 snare is a perfectly normal combination.

INSTALLING

Two separate packages, with different lives. The plugin is small and updated often; the library is heavy and rarely changes.

THE PLUGIN

AudioXL-DRUMS-1.0.0-macOS.pkg

VST3, Audio Unit and the standalone application.

THE LIBRARY

AudioXL-DRUMS-Library-1.0.0-macOS.pkg

The **3469 samples**. Installer.app lets you pick the drive, external included: the plugin finds the library on its own.

NOTE

On first launch the plugin runs as a demo: it plays for ten minutes and then the output goes silent. The serial goes in **PREFERENCES > LICENSE**. See the last chapter.

VOICES

8

STEPS

16

SAMPLES

3469

GROOVES

136

THE WINDOW

TOP

Groove, kit and transport.

MIDDLE

The step grid.

BELOW

A row of tabs: **VOICE** for the selected voice, **MASTER FX RACK** for the effects, **BROWSER** to search across kits, samples and grooves.



FIG. 01 The VOICE page: source on the left, nine knobs on the right.

02 — THE SEQUENCER

EIGHT TRACKS, SIXTEEN STEPS

A grid of **8 tracks** by **16 steps**. Every step has three states: **rest**, **hit**, **accented hit**. Click to write, drag to fill several steps in one gesture.

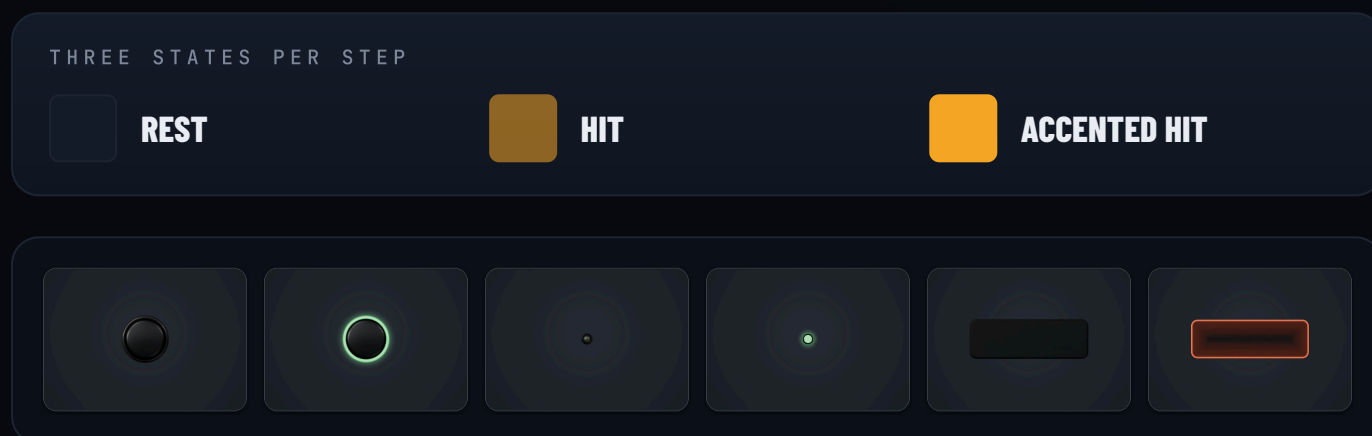


FIG. 02 Transport and grid: play off and on, LED off and on, button off and on. These are the Blender renders the skin takes its frames from.

CONTROL	RANGE	WHAT IT DOES
SEQ A B C D	4 sequences	Four chainable sequences. Right-click a letter to copy another sequence into it or to empty it.
CHAIN	1 ... 4	How many sequences go into the loop. The others stay in memory, they simply don't play. The button of the one currently playing lights up green.
STEPS	1 ... 16	Shortens every sequence. It combines with the chain, so four 12-step sequences make a 48-step loop .

CONTROL	RANGE	WHAT IT DOES
SWING	50 ... 75 %	From 50 % (straight) to 75 %. It delays the even sixteenths; at 66.7 % the ratio is exactly triplet.
ACCENT	knob	How far an accented hit stands out from the rest, like the knob on a TR.
INTERNAL	BPM	The tempo while the host is stopped. If the host is playing, the sequencer follows it sample-accurately .

HARDWARE FEEL

The closed hat chokes the open one, as on a real machine.

CHAIN 4 × STEPS 12

= 48-step loop



UNDO AND REDO

UNDO

REDO

cmd Z

cmd shift Z

64 steps

At the bottom of the window. The history covers everything: steps, knobs, kits, effect profiles, loaded samples, copied sequences.

Operations that move many things at once count as a **single step**: loading a groove changes pattern, kit and effect profile, and undoing it takes all three back in one go.

Dragging to write eight steps also costs **one undo, not eight**.

03 — THE VOICES

NINE KNOBS, ONE LAYOUT

The eight tracks share the same nine controls, in the same places: your hand learns where DECAY is and finds it again on any instrument. **Only the first four labels change**, because they describe the engine.



FIG. 03 Knob, HIT pad at rest and pressed, drop-down: the pieces of the VOICE page, modelled and rendered in Blender.

VOICE		1	2	3	4
I BD kick		TUNE	DECAY	CLICK	BEND
I SD snare		TUNE	DECAY	TONE	SNAP
I CP clap		TONE	DECAY	WIDTH	SPREAD
I CH / OH hat		TUNE	DECAY	HPF	NOISE
I LT tom		TUNE	DECAY	SKIN	BEND
I RS rim		TUNE	DECAY	RES	NOISE
I CY cymbal		TUNE	DECAY	HPF	NOISE

Then, on every voice: **DRIVE** **LEVEL** **PAN** **REVERB** **DELAY**

REAL SYNTHESIS

The engines are real synthesis, not samples.

KICK

A sine with a pitch envelope and a click.

SNARE

Body plus filtered noise.

CLAP

Three banded reflections.

HATS & CYMBALS

A six-square-wave bank in 808 ratios.

RIM

An impulse through a resonant filter.

HARDWARE FEEL

The closed hat chokes the open one, as on a real machine.

SAMPLE MODE

The two tabs **SYNTH** and **SAMPLE** choose where the voice's sound comes from. In **SAMPLE** the first four knobs change job and the labels say so.

Switching to **SYNTH**, the sample stays in memory: only the mode changes, and one click brings it back. The waveform box says so, printing **sample not active** instead of letting you think the load failed.

Knob	Range	In Sample Mode
PITCH	±24 st	Plus or minus 24 semitones.
DECAY	knob	How long the sample rings.
FILTER	LP ↔ HP	Low-pass below centre, high-pass above.
START	knob	Where playback begins in the file.



FIG. 04 In SAMPLE mode the box shows the waveform, with the START and DECAY bars.

THE THREE MENUS

- KIT** Changes the sound of the selected voice only – engine, colour and sends – leaving the others as they are. It doubles as “reset this voice” after you have edited it by hand.
- SAMPLE** Opens the library and changes only the file on this voice, without touching level, pan and sends. It is what you want in order to try one snare after another without losing the mix. With a SYNTH kit the row stays empty: that voice is not reading any file.
- COLOUR** The output conversion stage of the single voice. **MASTER** means no stage of its own: the rack’s global model applies.

Below there are **LOAD** for any file, **X** to remove the sample and **HIT** to audition the voice. An audio file can also be **dragged straight onto the row** in the grid.

WAV

AIF

MP3

FLAC

OGG

04 — KITS AND GROOVES

TWO VERSIONS OF EVERY MACHINE

The KIT menu shows, inside the same brand folder, the **SYNTH kits** (the synthesis engines, tuned preset by preset) and the **SAMPLE kits** (the samples of the real machine). They are two ways of having the same machine and both are visible, so you never have to guess which side the sound you want is on.

KIT MENU

▼ Roland

TR-909 SYNTH

TR-909 RAVE SYNTH

TR-909 SAMPLE (8/8)

TR-808 SAMPLE (8/8)

SYNTH KITS

77

SAMPLE KITS

68

The number next to the sampled kits says how many of the eight voices that machine can cover.

GROOVES

A hundred and thirty-six patterns with a suggested tempo and swing, each paired with a kit and an effect profile, split into twenty-eight genre folders:

HOUSE

TECHNO

ACID

ELECTRO

BREAKS

JUNGLE

GARAGE

HIP HOP

LATIN

AFRO

BASS

CLUB

DISCO

TRANCE

EDM

DOWNTempo

SYNTHWAVE

HARDCORE

INDUSTRIAL

FUNK

ROCK

POP

R&B

REGGAE

AMBIENT

EXPERIMENTAL

WORLD

JUKE

NOTE

Grooves and kits are independent: you can put a house pattern on an SP-1200 or a boom bap on a 909. Grooves are also exposed as programs, so they show up in the DAW's own preset menu.

05 — THE SAMPLE LIBRARY

3469 SAMPLES, 68 MACHINES

The plugin ships with 3469 samples taken from 68 real machines, across **fourteen brands**:

| ROLAND

| BOSS

| ALESIS

| CASIO

| KORG

| YAMAHA

| OBERHEIM

| E-MU

| LINN

| SIMMONS

| AKAI

| ACETONE

| ELEKTRON

| BUCHLA

The menu is organised in levels: **brand** > **machine** > **instrument** > **sample**

HOW THE SAMPLES ARE NAMED

Samples are called **TYPE NN** (SNARE 03), and in full **MACHINE TYPE NN** (TR-808 SNARE 03) where the machine they come from isn't otherwise visible.

The file name is never shown: in the packs it carries the signature of whoever bundled them, which tells you the seller and not the instrument. Nothing is renamed on disk: this is only the label.

WHICH SAMPLE ENDS UP ON WHICH VOICE

For kick, snare, clap, tom and rim the first of the category will do. For hats and cymbals it won't: in these packs the numbering is the **degree of opening**, not a ranking. The closed hat takes the shortest and the open hat the longest, which is after all the definition of the two sounds.

HATS & CYMBALS — THE NUMBER IS THE DEGREE OF OPENING

HAT 01		CH • closed hat
HAT 02		
HAT 03		
HAT 04		
HAT 05		
HAT 06		OH • open hat

Illustration: the closed hat takes the shortest, the open hat the longest.

WHERE THE LIBRARY LIVES

The plugin looks for it in this order:

- 01 the folder chosen with **LIBRARY FOLDER** on the **BROWSER** page, remembered between sessions
- 02 `~/Library/Application Support/AudioXL/DRUMS/Samples`
- 03 `/Library/Application Support/AudioXL/DRUMS/Samples`
- 04 the same folder on a **mounted external drive**

That last entry is what makes the library work from an external drive without having to point at it by hand every time. If the drive isn't there, the browser says so instead of pretending nothing happened.

NOTE

To add machines of your own, create the folders following the **Brand/Machine/sample.wav** pattern and press **RESCAN**: they appear at once, with no need to restart the host.

EIGHT CATEGORIES AND MISC

The instrument is derived from the file name. **1850 samples out of 3469** land in one of the eight categories; the rest don't disappear, they sit under **MISC**.

DERIVED FROM THE FILE NAME

1850 / 3469 in the eight categories

8 categories

MISC – the rest stays, it doesn't disappear

Sixteen machines have purely numeric names: for those there is only MISC, because guessing would be worse than letting the ear choose.

06 — THE BROWSER

ONE LIST, ONE SEARCH BOX

The BROWSER page puts synth kits, sampled machines, single samples and grooves into one list with one search box. With **77 kits**, **68 machines**, **3469 samples** and **136 grooves**, menus are for picking something you already know you want; this is where you go looking.

SEARCH

By name, brand or genre: **909** pulls up the synth kits, the sampled machine and all of its files; **house** pulls up the grooves too.

TYPE FILTERS

Four filters to switch on and off, each with its own colour, the same as the tag on the row.

GROUP COLUMN

On the left: brands and genres, to narrow things down without typing.

AUDITION

One click auditions a sample right away, on a utility voice that doesn't go through the rack and doesn't touch the eight tracks.

LOAD

LOAD or a double click applies the row: a groove loads the pattern, a kit the eight voices, a sample goes onto the selected track.



FIG. 05 The BROWSER page with the four type filters.

07 — THE EFFECTS RACK

EIGHT MODULES ON THE MASTER

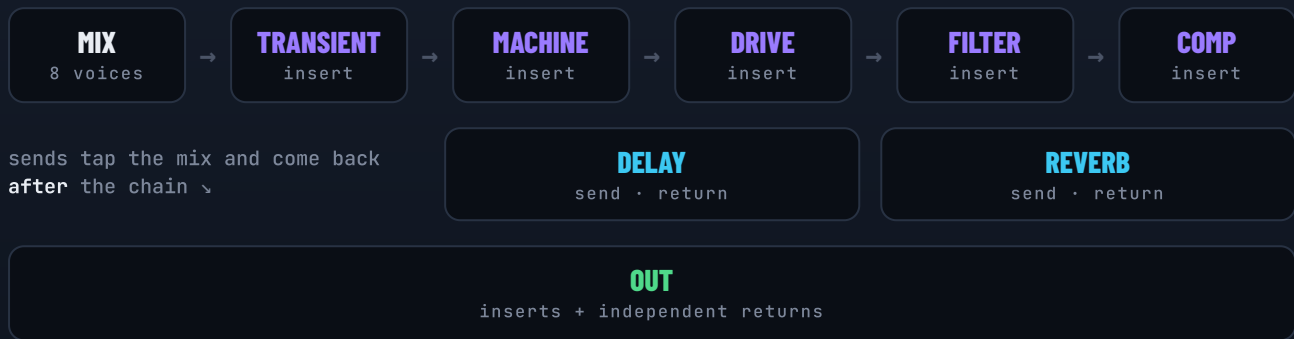
Each with its own bypass LED.

MODULE	CONTROLS
TRANSIENT	ATTACK, SUSTAIN. Bipolar : you can take away as well as add.
MACHINE	Conversion model, AMOUNT. Bit depth, sample rate, bandwidth and saturation of the classic machines.
DRIVE	Type (tape, tube, clip, fold), DRIVE, TONE, MIX, NOISE.
FILTER	Type (LP, HP, BP), CUTOFF, RESO.
COMP	THRESH, RATIO, ATTACK, RELEASE, MAKEUP, MIX, with a reduction meter.
DELAY	Synced division or free time, FEEDBK, TONE, WIDTH (from stereo to ping-pong), MIX.
REVERB	SIZE, DAMP, PREDLY, WIDTH, MIX.
MASTER PRESET	Twelve profiles:
CLEAN PUNCH WARM LO-FI RAVE DUB TRAP INDUSTRIAL AIR TAPE GLUE TUNNEL CRUSHED	

The **green LED** inside the MASTER FX RACK button switches the whole rack on and off; the rest of the button opens the page. The LED stays visible from the VOICE page too, so you can compare with and without the rack while working on sounds.

INSERTS AND SENDS ARE NOT THE SAME THING

SIGNAL PATH OF THE MASTER RACK



Transient, Machine, Drive, Filter and Comp are **inserts**: they work on the whole mix. Delay and Reverb are marked **SEND** because they are **returns**: they come back in after the master chain, so drive, filter and compressor don't colour them again. The two sends are independent of each other: what you send to the delay never ends up in the reverb.

NOTE

The REVERB, DELAY and DRIVE of a single voice do not go through the rack. The sends on the voice panel knobs have two engines of their own, always running: you hear them with the rack switched off. From the rack modules they only take the character – time, damping, size, pre-delay – not the switches.



FIG. 06 The effects page, with the SYNC MASTER RACK button at the bottom right.

08 — LINKING WITH AUDIOXL MASTER RACK

ONE CHAIN, TWO PLUGINS

The **SYNC MASTER RACK** button, at the bottom of the effects page next to **MASTER PRESET**, is the same switch that the other plugin calls **SYNC DRUMS**: turn it on from either side, it makes no difference, and the two windows stay in agreement.



FIG. 07 The states you see from the other side: SYNC DRUMS off and on, padlock open and closed.

SEPARATE

Each on its own: this rack is all in here.

WAITING

On, but there is nobody on the other side yet. You can switch it on before opening Master Rack: when it arrives, the link engages by itself.

CHAIN HANDED OVER

Linked: from here on the one doing the colouring is Master Rack.

Open AudioXL DRUMS on its own and nothing changes: the button is off. **The link is something you ask for.** When it engages, the whole master rack goes over to Master Rack exactly as it stands – transient, machine, drive, filter, compressor, delay and reverb, values and menus included – and all seven go into bypass here. Over there you find the very same chain, and from that moment the knobs are its own.

TRAVELS TO MASTER RACK

- Transient
- Machine
- Drive
- Filter
- Compressor
- Delay
- Reverb

values and menus included

STAYS IN DRUMS

- Voice REVERB send
 - Voice DELAY send
 - Voice DRIVE
 - Voice CLICK
- one engine per track, per channel

NOTE

What travels is the master rack, not the sends of a single voice. The REVERB and DELAY knobs on the voice panel have two engines of their own, one per track, and they stay here: a tail on the snare is not a tail on the mix. The DRIVE and CLICK of each voice don't travel either: they are controls inside that track's synthesis engine, not rack modules, and they stay per channel – the rack's DRIVE and the voice's DRIVE share a name but not a stage.

The stages Master Rack has on top – **EQ, exciter, maximizer and clipper** – are switched off when the link engages, otherwise what you would hear wouldn't be the DRUMS chain but the DRUMS chain plus four stages left on by a preset chosen earlier. **Not the limiter**: that is protection, and pulling it out from under a master bus mid-take would be a poor way to be consistent.

Turn the sync off – from either side – and the switches go back as they were, with the values they had before handing the chain over. If Master Rack disappears without saying goodbye, **the rack comes back on its own after a second and a half**.

THE PADLOCK

A padlock, next to Master Rack's MASTER PRESET menu, decides whether that plugin follows every change made here (**open**, the factory setting) or whether the preset it has built stays protected (**closed**) – the chain is handed over all the same, only nothing arrives on the other side. Details in the Master Rack manual.

09 — BOUNCE AND MIDI OUTPUT

OUT OF THE BOX

BOUNCE IN PLACE

BOUNCE IN PLACE writes one file per sounding voice to disk, plus the mix. You choose:

- 01 how many **loops**
- 02 whether to add a **tail**
- 03 whether to honour **mute and solo**
- 04 two mixes: **with the rack and without**

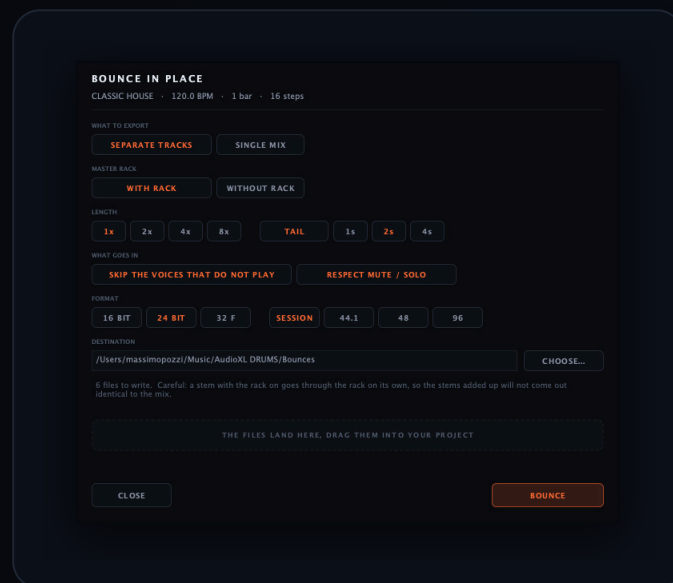


FIG. 08 The bounce window.

MIDI OUTPUT

The eight voices can send their notes to another machine: you choose the channel, and the **accent** travels as **velocity**. Every note that goes on is turned off again.

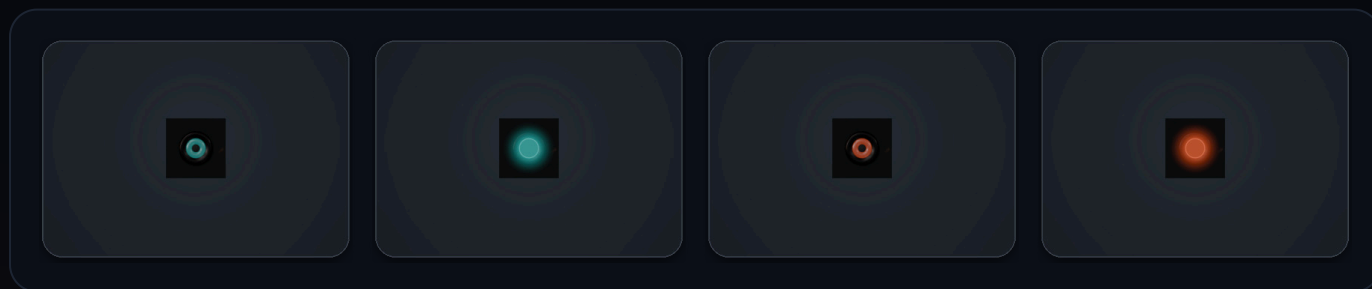


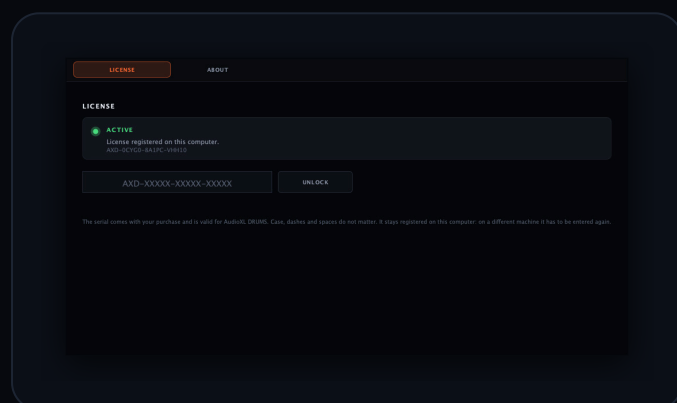
FIG. 09 The chassis jacks: audio out and MIDI out, idle and live.

10 — AUTHORISATION

THE SOUND STOPS, THE WORK DOESN'T

Without a serial, AudioXL DRUMS runs as a demo: it plays for **ten minutes** and then the output goes silent. What is counted is minutes of actual work, not the clock. Everything else keeps running – the sequencer advances, parameters respond, the pattern saves.

To unlock: **PREFERENCES > LICENSE**, the first tab. Paste the serial you received with your purchase and press **UNLOCK**. The limits disappear immediately, with nothing to reopen and nothing lost of what you were doing.



SERIAL FORMAT

AXD-XXXXX-XXXXX-XXXXX

Type it without worrying about case, dashes or spaces. The letters that get confused when reading off a sheet – an **o** for a zero, an **l** for a one – are accepted all the same.

FIG. 10 The LICENSE tab in the preferences.

NOTE

The **serial is registered on this computer**: on another machine it has to be entered again. An AudioXL DRUMS serial will not open AudioXL Master Rack: they are two products with two different keys.



NOW HIT PLAY

Eight voices. Sixteen steps. Synth
or sample, on every track.

